erected.[32] Thus, in the city of the Renaissance and beautiful bridges like Ponte Vecchio and Ponte Santa Trinita, the bridge leading to Cascine Park was named Ponte all'Indiano. Along with eating gelato at Santa Trinita and sandwiches at All'Antico Vinaio, it is a part of Florence no visitor from India can afford to miss. It is literally a bridge between Europe and India.

Model Minorities: North America

In 1833, residents of Calcutta received a pleasant 100-ton surprise from a ship that had sailed for four months all the way from Boston. White and cold, packaged ice soon made waves among the Indian elite and transformed the idea of a dessert. This cool idea was the brainchild of Frederic Tudor (1783–1864), known as the Boston Ice King and founder of the Tudor Ice Company, whose mission was to ship manufactured ice from New England to the Tropics. He belonged to the 'Boston Brahmins', a term coined to describe the wealthy aristocracy of the New England area in the 19th century which emphasized core values of education, hard work, culture and thrift. In America, it was a time when the word 'Indians' referred to the native American Indians and not the residents of India. A century and a half later, it would be the Indian-Americans and the Brahmins in Boston that would make waves among the American elite.

Dubbed as 'the other 1 per cent' by political scientist Devesh Kapur and others, Indian migration to the United States in recent decades appears to be the most selective migration in human history, on account of 'triple selection'.[33] On the supply side, higher education in India was historically accessible only to the top-end of the social and economic hierarchy, while financing emigration for studies or work was feasible only for a few. On the demand side, the American immigration rules favoured workers in particular high-skilled sectors. As a consequence, Indian-Americans outperform every other sub-group in America in terms of income and education.

Migrant links between the USA and India were first fostered in the 19th century when missionaries and traders moved from the USA to India, and